

ONE STOP IMMIGRATION STATION

Development Session Summary

Web Sessions 4 & 5 — News/Videos CMS + Blog Filtering + Notifications

Date: June 09, 2026

Branch: [mobile](#) → [merged into main](#) → [Live on Vercel](#) ■

1. What Happened This Session

This session completed two full planned work batches (Web Sessions 4 and 5), fixed a production deployment issue, and successfully deployed everything to the live site for the first time in several sessions.

Result: The live site at onestop-immigrationstation-web.vercel.app now has ALL features from Sessions 1–5 fully deployed and working in production.

2. Web Session 4 — News / Videos CMS

The goal was to build a proper content management system for the blog, videos, and USCIS news — all from one admin interface.

What was built:

Feature	Status	Details
Post Type System	■ Done	Blog CMS now has 3 content types: Article (→/blog), YouTube Video (→/videos with embedded player), USCIS News (→/blog, auto-imported as draft)
YouTube Video Posts	■ Done	Admin pastes a YouTube URL → live preview appears in the form → published video embeds on the /videos page
USCIS News Type	■ Done	Always saved as draft — admin must review before publishing. Auto-imported posts land here.
/videos Page Rewrite	■ Done	Now pulls live YouTube videos from the database. Falls back to placeholder cards if no videos published yet.
Archive Logic	■ Done	Posts 0–90 days: main list. Posts 91–365 days: collapsible Archive section. Posts > 1 year: auto-deleted by cron.
USCIS RSS Cron Job	■ Done	Runs daily at 6am UTC. Fetches 2 USCIS feeds (Newsroom + Alerts). Inserts new items as drafts. Skips duplicates. Emails admin when new drafts arrive.
Database Migration 012	■ Done	Added post_type, youtube_url, source_url columns to blog_posts table. Run in Supabase SQL Editor.
CRON_SECRET	■ Done	Added to Vercel env vars — protects the cron endpoint from unauthorized calls.

■ The USCIS RSS cron runs automatically on Vercel daily. No manual action needed. When it runs, the admin gets an email with a link to review the new drafts.

3. Web Session 5 — Blog Filtering + Notifications

The goal was to make the blog sidebar actually work (it had dead links) and build a real-time notification bell in the portal.

What was built:

Feature	Status	Details
Blog Category Filter	■ Done	Clicking a category in the sidebar now filters posts. URL becomes <code>/blog?category=H-1B</code> . Live counts shown from database.
Blog Pagination	■ Done	8 posts per page. Prev/Next buttons with "Page X of Y". Works with category filter too: <code>/blog?category=H-1B&page;=2</code>
Active Category Highlight	■ Done	Selected category shown bold + highlighted. "Clear" link resets to all posts.
Empty State	■ Done	If a category has no posts, a friendly message is shown with a link back to all posts.
Notification Bell	■ Done	Bell icon in both portal topbars (client dashboard + admin panel). Shows red badge with unread count.
Real-Time Updates	■ Done	Bell updates instantly when a new notification arrives — no page refresh needed (Supabase Realtime).
Notification Dropdown	■ Done	Click bell → dropdown shows last 15 notifications with icon, title, description, and time ago.
Mark as Read	■ Done	Click a notification → marks as read + navigates to the relevant page. "Mark all read" button clears badge.
Notification Triggers	■ Done	Case status change, timeline event added, appointment confirmed/cancelled all create notifications.
New API Route	■ Done	<code>/api/admin/add-timeline-event</code> — inserts timeline event + notification in one server-side call.

■ Known gap: Ticket replies do not yet create a notification in the bell. The client still gets an email, but no bell badge. This is logged in ISSUES.md for a future session.

4. Production Deployment Fix (Important)

A significant issue was discovered and fixed during this session.

The Problem:

All development work (Sessions 1–5) had been committed to the **mobile** branch. The **main** branch — which Vercel deploys from — was missing everything. The live site had been running old code for weeks without us noticing because everything worked locally.

The Fix:

Merged the **mobile** branch into **main** (109 files, no conflicts) and pushed. Vercel then built and deployed all the latest code successfully.

Also fixed: A TypeScript error in DownloadPdf.tsx that had been silently ignored locally but caused production builds to fail.

Going forward: After every development session, merge mobile → main so the live site stays current. Command: `git checkout main → git merge mobile --no-edit → git push origin main → git checkout mobile`

5. What Is Still Left to Build

Web App — Remaining items:

Item	Priority	Notes
Ticket reply notification	Low	Ticket reply does not create a bell notification. Client gets email but no badge. Small fix needed in the ticket reply route.
L-1 USCIS Pre-Fill PDF	Low	L-1 visa uses the same I-129 form as H-1B but with the L Classification Supplement. Mapping not yet written.
Custom Domain	Medium	Point onestopimmigrationstation.com to Vercel. GoDaddy DNS: A record → 76.76.21.21, CNAME www → cname.vercel-dns.com
middleware.ts rename	Low	Next.js 16 deprecation warning — rename middleware.ts to proxy.ts. Cosmetic only, works fine as-is.
Vercel Analytics	Low	One-click enable in Vercel dashboard → Analytics tab.

Mobile App — Remaining:

Phase 6 (Polish + App Store) is the only remaining mobile task. Phases 1–5 are fully complete.

6. Decisions Needed From You

■ Custom Domain Timing

When do you want to switch onestopimmigrationstation.com to point at Vercel? This is a 10-minute GoDaddy DNS change. Recommended: after all features are tested and signed off.

■ USCIS RSS Feed Approval

The cron job will start importing USCIS news as drafts automatically. You will get an email each time it runs. Do you want to review and publish these, or should they be auto-published?

■ Ticket Reply Notification

Should we add the missing bell notification for ticket replies in the next session, or is email-only acceptable for now?

■ Next Session Focus

Web app is essentially feature-complete. Options: (1) Polish + testing, (2) Custom domain setup, (3) Start on App Store submission for mobile.

7. Complete Feature Inventory — Live in Production

Every item below is live on the production site right now:

- ■ Public website (Home, Blog, Videos, Success Stories, Press, Contact)
- ■ Blog with category filtering, pagination (8/page), and archive section
- ■ Videos page with live YouTube embeds from CMS
- ■ USCIS News auto-import (daily cron, draft-first, admin email notification)
- ■ Blog/Videos CMS with 3 post types (Article, YouTube Video, USCIS News)
- ■ Client signup, login (email + Google OAuth), forgot/reset password
- ■ Client dashboard: Cases, Appointments, Documents, Profile, Support Tickets
- ■ Visa intake questionnaires (all 5 types: H-1B, L-1, Green Card, K-1, Family)
- ■ Save & resume questionnaires — client can close and pick up where they left off
- ■ Appointment booking from real lawyer availability slots
- ■ 2 free consultations per client — tracked automatically
- ■ Admin panel: all sections (Applications, Cases, Users, Appointments, Blog CMS, Slots)
- ■ Lawyer sees only their own appointments (security fix)
- ■ Create Case directly (walk-in clients — no application needed)
- ■ Case status updates (7 states) + client email on every change

- ■ Case timeline events — lawyer adds, client notified
- ■ Resend Setup Email button — regenerate lawyer password links
- ■ Appointment confirmation/cancellation email with location + meeting link
- ■ USCIS Pre-Fill PDF (I-129, I-130, I-129F, I-140) — organized by form part/item
- ■ Summary PDF download (all questionnaire answers formatted)
- ■ In-portal notification bell — real-time, unread badge, mark as read
- ■ All emails via Resend from noreply@onestopimmigrationstation.com

The web application is production-ready. All planned features from Web Sessions 1–5 are live. The remaining items are enhancements, not blockers.